

Where to Watch — Companion to the Sabbatical Film Syllabus

All 85 core films, US availability, checked 17 August 2026 via JustWatch.

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The headline

50 of 85 core films (59%) are on the Criterion Channel right now. The other 35 break down as:

Where the other 35 live	Count
Free via Kanopy / Tubi / Plex / Hoopla	20
HBO Max (not on Criterion)	5
Rental or purchase only	10

Good news on the five additions: they cost nothing. *Meshes of the Afternoon*, *Night and Fog*, and *La Jetée* are all on Criterion. *The Cabinet of Dr. Caligari* and *Un Chien Andalou* are public domain in the US and free in half a dozen places. The rental budget below is unchanged.

The gaps are not where you'd expect. Criterion covers Units 6, 7, 9, and 10 — Japan, the Bergman/Dreyer/Tarkovsky stretch, Hong Kong/Taiwan, and India/Iran/Senegal — **completely, 32 for 32**. That is precisely the material that's hard to find anywhere else, and it's the strongest argument for the subscription.

Where Criterion is thin is **American studio cinema**: Unit 2 (1 of 8) and Unit 8 (0 of 8). But those films are the easiest in the world to find — most are free on Kanopy or Tubi, and the rest rent for \$3.99. So the coverage gap and the difficulty gap run in opposite directions, which is lucky.

What to actually subscribe to

Criterion Channel — yes, clearly. \$10.99/mo. Carries 47 core films including every single film in four units.

A library card for Kanopy — yes, and it's free. Kanopy alone covers 18 of the 33 Criterion gaps, including most of Unit 3 (silents) and a good chunk of Unit 8. Check whether Berkeley's library login works, and whether your public library card does too — many people have access through both, and the borrowing limits are separate.

HBO Max — optional. It duplicates a lot of Criterion. It's *uniquely* required for only four core films: *Singin' in the Rain* (W7), *Spirited Away* (W39), *Portrait of a Lady on Fire* (W39), and *2001* (W40). All four are also rentable. Skip it, or subscribe for one month in June 2027.

Everything else: rent as you go. Budget roughly **\$45–55 in rentals for the whole year** (about 12 films at \$3.99). Cheaper than a second subscription.

The one real problem film

Nashville (1975), **Week 26** — no subscription, no free option, and no rental. Purchase only, about \$4.99 digital. It has drifted in and out of streaming for years. Options: buy it, check the library for a physical copy, or substitute *McCabe & Mrs. Miller* (the listed extension for that week, and a fine Altman in its own right).

Important caveat

The Criterion Channel rotates its catalogue monthly. These 47 are on today. Units 6 through 13 don't come up until January–July 2027, so some will have cycled off and others cycled on by then. Re-check a month ahead of each unit. The rotation is usually generous in both directions — Criterion adds ~45 titles a month.

By unit

Legend: C = Criterion Channel · Free = Kanopy/Tubi/Plex/Hoopla/etc. · \$ = rental price

Unit 1 · The Grammar (Weeks 1–3)

Film	C	Elsewhere
Citizen Kane (1941)	—	Rent \$3.99 Apple/Amazon
Rear Window (1954)	—	TCM; rent \$3.99
Do the Right Thing (1989)	—	Free on YouTube (ads); rent \$3.99
Chungking Express (1994)	✓	HBO Max, TCM
Rashomon (1950)	✓	Free: Kanopy, Tubi, Plex
The 400 Blows (1959)	✓	Free: Kanopy, Tubi, Plex

3 of 6 on Criterion. The three misses are all cheap rentals.

Week 1's extension, *North by Northwest* (1959), is not on Criterion but is **free on Plex and Tubi** — so taking the extension costs nothing.

Unit 2 · The Studio System (Weeks 4–7)

Film	C	Elsewhere
It Happened One Night (1934)	—	Free: Tubi, Roku, YouTube
His Girl Friday (1940)	—	Free: Kanopy, Hoopla, Tubi, Pluto, Plex
Red River (1948)	—	Free: Tubi, Hoopla, YouTube
The Searchers (1956)	✓	YouTube TV
Double Indemnity (1944)	—	MGM+, Philo; rent \$3.99
The Third Man (1949)	—	Free: Kanopy, Tubi, Plex
Singin' in the Rain (1952)	—	HBO Max; rent \$5.99
Sunset Boulevard (1950)	—	Free: Kanopy, Hoopla

Criterion's worst unit — 1 of 8 — and it barely matters. Five are free, one is a rental.

Unit 3 · Silents (Weeks 8–10)

Film	C	Elsewhere
Sherlock Jr. (1924)	—	Free: Kanopy, Tubi, Plex
The General (1926)	—	Free: Kanopy, Hoopla, Tubi, Roku, Plex; Prime Video
The Cabinet of Dr. Caligari (1920)	—	Free: Kanopy, Hoopla, Plex, Roku — public domain in the US; also Shudder, AMC+
Sunrise (1927)	—	Free: Kanopy, Hoopla, Tubi, Roku
The Passion of Joan of Arc (1928)	✓	HBO Max; free: Tubi, Plex
Man with a Movie Camera (1929)	—	Free: Kanopy, Tubi
Battleship Potemkin (1925)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy, Hoopla, Tubi, Plex
Un Chien Andalou (1929)	—	Free: Kanopy, Tubi, Fandor — effectively public domain
Meshes of the Afternoon (1943)	✓	Free: Kanopy

Every film in this unit is free somewhere. Zero cost for the whole unit — including all three additions.

Unit 4 · Italy (Weeks 11–13)

Film	C	Elsewhere
Rome, Open City (1945)	✓	HBO Max
Bicycle Thieves (1948)	✓	HBO Max, Prime Video; free: Kanopy
L'Avventura (1960)	✓	HBO Max
Il Sorpasso (1962)	✓	Criterion only (else rent \$3.99)
8½ (1963)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy, Tubi, Plex
The Conformist (1970)	—	Free: Kanopy, Hoopla

5 of 6. The miss is free on Kanopy.

Unit 5 · French New Wave (Weeks 14–16)

Film	C	Elsewhere
Bob le Flambeur (1956)	—	Free: Kanopy
Breathless (1960)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy
Cléo from 5 to 7 (1962)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy
Jules and Jim (1962)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy

Film	C	Elsewhere
Contempt (1963)	—	Free: Tubi, Kanopy — no rental exists, so use these
Le Samouraï (1967)	✓	Prime Video, HBO Max; free: Kanopy, Tubi, Plex

4 of 6, both misses free. Note that Contempt cannot be rented anywhere — Tubi or Kanopy is the only route.

Unit 6 · Japan (Weeks 17–20) — 7 of 7 on Criterion

Film	C	Elsewhere
Late Spring (1949)	✓	HBO Max, Fandor
Tokyo Story (1953)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy, Plex
Seven Samurai (1954)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy, Tubi, Plex
Ugetsu (1953)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy, Plex
Harakiri (1962)	✓	Criterion only (else rent \$3.99)
High and Low (1963)	✓	HBO Max; free: Tubi, Plex
Woman in the Dunes (1964)	✓	Criterion only (else rent \$3.99)

Unit 7 · The Northern Interior (Weeks 21–23) — 6 of 6 on Criterion

Film	C	Elsewhere
Wild Strawberries (1957)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy
The Seventh Seal (1957)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy, Tubi, Plex
Persona (1966)	✓	HBO Max
Ordet (1955)	✓	Criterion or Darkroom only — no rental exists
Stalker (1979)	✓	HBO Max
Solaris (1972)	✓	HBO Max; free: Tubi, Plex

Watch Ordet while Criterion has it — there is currently no way to rent it.

Unit 8 · New Hollywood (Weeks 24–27) — 0 of 8 on Criterion

Film	C	Elsewhere
Bonnie and Clyde (1967)	—	MGM+, Philo; rent \$3.99
The Graduate (1967)	—	Free: Kanopy, Tubi, Plex, Roku; Prime Video
The Godfather (1972)	—	Paramount+, MGM+; rent \$3.99
Chinatown (1974)	—	MGM+, Philo; rent \$3.99
Nashville (1975)	—	Purchase only (~\$4.99). See note above.
Taxi Driver (1976)	—	Rent \$3.99

Film	C	Elsewhere
Days of Heaven (1978)	—	Free: Kanopy, Hoopla, YouTube
Apocalypse Now (1979)	—	Free: Plex; Lionsgate+

The most expensive unit. Two free, one purchase-only, five rentals — roughly \$20 for the month, or free if you add MGM+ or Philo for one month (either covers Bonnie and Clyde, Chinatown, and Double Indemnity from Unit 2).

Unit 9 · Hong Kong & Taiwan (Weeks 28–30) — 5 of 5 on Criterion

Film	C	Elsewhere
Days of Being Wild (1990)	✓	HBO Max — no rental exists
In the Mood for Love (2000)	✓	HBO Max
Yi Yi (2000)	✓	Criterion only (else rent \$2.99)
Hard Boiled (1992)	✓	Free: Kanopy, Pluto, Plex
A Brighter Summer Day (1991)	✓	Criterion only (else rent \$2.99)

Unit 10 · Off the Usual Axis (Weeks 31–33) — 6 of 6 on Criterion

Film	C	Elsewhere
Pather Panchali (1955)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy, Plex, Tubi
Charulata (1964)	✓	Criterion only (else rent \$3.99)
Close-Up (1990)	✓	Criterion only (else rent \$3.99)
Taste of Cherry (1997)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy — no rental exists
Black Girl (1966)	✓	HBO Max; free: Plex
Touki Bouki (1973)	✓	HBO Max, MUBI

This unit is the clearest case for the subscription — several of these are genuinely hard to find otherwise.

Unit 11 · Germany & the Political Film (Weeks 34–36)

Film	C	Elsewhere
Aguirre, the Wrath of God (1972)	—	Free: Kanopy, Pluto, Plex, Tubi, YouTube
Ali: Fear Eats the Soul (1974)	✓	HBO Max
The Battle of Algiers (1966)	✓	HBO Max; free: Kanopy, Plex, Tubi
Z (1969)	✓	HBO Max
Wings of Desire (1987)	✓	HBO Max

Film	C	Elsewhere
Night and Fog (1956)	✓	HBO Max; rent \$2.99
Come and See (1985)	✓	Criterion only (else rent \$3.99)

6 of 7, and Aguirre is free in five places.

Unit 12 · Cinema Now (Weeks 37–39)

Film	C	Elsewhere
A Separation (2011)	—	Hulu; rent \$3.99
4 Months, 3 Weeks and 2 Days (2007)	✓	Philo, AMC+
Memories of Murder (2003)	—	Rent \$3.99 — no subscription or free option
Parasite (2019)	—	Free: Kanopy ; rent \$0.99
Spirited Away (2001)	—	HBO Max; rent \$3.59
Portrait of a Lady on Fire (2019)	—	HBO Max; free: Kanopy

Criterion's weakest recent-cinema showing — 1 of 6 — but everything here is easy to get.

Unit 13 · Capstone (Weeks 40–42)

Film	C	Elsewhere
2001: A Space Odyssey (1968)	—	HBO Max, TCM; rent \$3.99
Playtime (1967)	✓	Free: Kanopy
La Jetée (1962)	✓	Criterion only (else rent \$2.99 Apple)
Mulholland Drive (2001)	—	Rent \$3.99 — no subscription or free option
Jeanne Dielman (1975)	✓	HBO Max

Rental shopping list

If you take Criterion + Kanopy and rent the rest, this is the full year's out-of-pocket:

Week	Film	Cost
1	Citizen Kane	\$3.99
1	Rear Window	\$3.99
6	Double Indemnity	\$3.99
7	Singin' in the Rain	\$5.99

Week	Film	Cost
24	Bonnie and Clyde	\$3.99
25	The Godfather	\$3.99
25	Chinatown	\$3.99
26	Nashville	~\$4.99 (purchase)
26	Taxi Driver	\$3.99
37	A Separation	\$3.99
38	Memories of Murder	\$3.99
39	Spirited Away	\$3.59
40	2001: A Space Odyssey	\$3.99
41	Mulholland Drive	\$3.99
	Total	~\$57

Adding one month of MGM+ during Unit 8 (February–March 2027) covers *Bonnie and Clyde*, *Chinatown*, and *Double Indemnity*, saving about \$12 on a ~\$6 subscription. Adding one month of HBO Max in June 2027 covers *2001* and *Spirited Away*.

Realistically: **~\$130 for the year** all in (Criterion at \$10.99 × 11 months, plus ~\$45 in rentals after the substitutions above), assuming Kanopy is free through your library.

Availability verified against JustWatch US on 17 August 2026, covering all 85 core films including the five later additions (Caligari, Un Chien Andalou, Meshes of the Afternoon, Night and Fog, La Jetée). Streaming rights change constantly; re-check each unit about a month before you start it.